

**Activity Report
Of
One Day Technical Workshop on
“ Current Status of Technical Assistance in Reconstruction and it's Challenges ”**



**Under Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform-Nepal
(HRRP), Rasuwa**

Organizers :



HRRP

Date: 14-Feb-2017

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background

Rasuwa is one of the 14 most earthquake affected districts comprising of 18 Village Development Committees (VDCs) each with 9 wards. More than 63% of the district's territory is at an elevation of more than 3000 meters. Of the remaining territory, most parts are located at an elevation between 1000 – 3000 meters. Around 619 people from the district died in the earthquake and most of those that died in the district were killed in an avalanche that buried inhabitants of Langtang village. Around 11,600 houses were damaged by the earthquake and other disasters such as landslide and fire that followed leaving 751 households in Haku severely damaged resulting in over 600 households living in temporary camps in different places. IDPs cannot return to their VDCs as their lands have been badly damaged by the landslide and earthquake and they have not received any additional support from the Government in terms of reallocation. 11,236 HHs were enlisted as eligible beneficiaries out of which 9,587 HHs signed grant agreement, 9,155 HHs received 1st instalment and second tranche of NRs 1,50,000 was released to 58 beneficiaries bank account.

Effective and quality technical assistance is a major challenge for successful reconstruction process. To identify gaps, duplication, constraints in reconstruction process and to develop mutual understanding and strategy, a common platform for sharing and jointly working mechanism is needed. Technical workshop acts as an open platform for partners and government to share their evidence based learning, best practices, challenges and a way forward for effective reconstruction process and will support for advocacy on current burning issues.

1.2 Workshop Goal

- Provide an opportunity for all relevant stakeholders to share their experiences in one platform.
- Identify the reconstruction current status in the district

1.3 Workshop Objectives

- To share the POs experiences on the housing reconstruction
- To collect the challenges on the Technical Assistance for safer reconstruction.
- To collect the ideas on possible improvement from field to provide the adequate Technical Assistance to ensure the safer reconstruction.
- To identify the gaps on the Technical Assistance in the District

- To identify the duplications and overlap on the Technical Assistance
- To evaluate the impact of IEC material developed and Disseminate by NRA and CLPIU

1.4 Workshop Participants

Participating Agencies : NRA, DUDBC/DLPUI, NRCS, HELVETAS, Cordaid, Build change, Manikor Society, DEPROSC Nepal, DFID, SP, NSET/Baliyo Ghar, LACCoS.

There were 25 participants in the workshop. 4 engineers from DUDBC/DLPUI, 6 engineer and 3 sub engineer from POs, 9 program managers/officers, HRRP and 2 from NRA were present.

Laxmi Parsad Bhatta, National Technical Coordination Officer from HRRP was the facilitator of the workshop.

Rijan Gajurel (HRRP) facilitated and assisted in program and welcomed all the participants and thanked all the invitees for accepting the invitation and attending the workshop.

HRRP clarified the importance of technical support and its challenges faced among the POs in the district and requested all the PO's to support and hold each other hand to develop and strengthen the coordination capacity in relation to technical assistance for the district.

1.5 Workshop Schedule

One Day Technical Workshop on "Current Status of Technical Assistance in Reconstruction and it's Challenges"			
Time		Session	Description
9:00	9:30	S 0	Arrival/Registration/Breakfast
9:30	9:45	S 1	Opening Session : Introduction, Overview and Objective of Workshop, Group Photographs
9:45	11:30	S 2	Experience Sharing on Technical Assistance in the District from POs
11:30	12:15		Lunch
12:15	14:15	S 3	Evaluation of Reconstructed Houses w.r.t. Standard Operating Procedures (SOP), Nepal National Building Codes (NBC ** 2015) and Updated Technical Guidelines - Challenges in Technical Assistance in the Reconstruction Works - Possible ideas to improve the technical assistance to make reconstruction more smooth and compliance standards (Group Work)
14:15	15:15	S 4	Group work Presentation
15:15	15:30		Tea
15:30	16:00	S 5	Overview on Published Documents by GON and its Current Implementation Status
16:00	16:15	S 0	Closing Session : Closing Remarks (NRA, DLPUI, POs)

The list of participants and Workshop Schedule is included in Annex 1.

1.6 Methodology

The workshop was conducted through interactive and participatory approach. Instead of one side delivery, participants were engaged in several discussions and group work.

The workshop was focus on current status of technical assistance and challenges with regards to technical assistance and other general challenges faced by POs as well as government. Participants were encouraged and advised to focus basically on 6 minimum packages recommended by NRA.

After the presentations, participants were divided into four groups and were given the task to gather ideas on challenges and possible measures to improve it. All the groups showed their innovative ideas and presented to all other participants.. All the ideas were noted and collected which will be forwarded to national level. These shall be compiled and shared centrally. The workshop was very interesting with innovative people's ideas so, all the participants were endangered into their task for the whole day.

1.7 Contents

Presentation from POs to share their experiences, achievement and challenges are as follows:

1.7.1 HELVTAS -On the Job Training (OJT) -Sanjib Kumar Rai

HELVATAS: Objective of On the Job Training (OJT), guideline for on the job training and Helvetas's modality for On the Job Training.

Challenges:

- Limited area/no enough space for building construction.
- Lack of good quality materials in some places: wood
- Coverage of all wards: Demonstration construction due to age limit.

1.7.2 Cordaid -Shelter, WASH, Livelihood, DRR and Protection - Ramesh Acharya

Cordaid shared that Second tranche has been distributed to 7 HH out of 380HH's in 2 VDC. Door to door assistance and BBS message ongoing. 4 drawing have been approved by DUDBC Rasuwa and 6 more designs has been submitted to CLPIU for approval.

Challenges:

Political statement confuses on the local community in reconstruction module. For example shelter grant.

- Insufficient skill masons in a Local Community for reconstruction within the timeframe.
- Insufficient of water in the community during the reconstruction.
- High expectation of beneficiary.
- Challenging time frame for the organization to complete the targeted approach within the end of 2017.

1.7.3 Nepal Red Cross Society -Shelter (443 target), Livelihood, Health, Wash, ICB - pawan Bhatta

NRCS shared that second tranche have started inThulogoun VDC, also formed shelter reconstruction committee for facilitating the reconstruction process.

Challenges:

- Lack of adequate models with different material that suits the community needs. (Timber structures, Block housing etc.)
- Local people do not follow all the technical guidelines and building code which was developed by government. At the same time it would be benefit to the local community if HRRP and government arrange some community technical workshops to encourage local community to enhance the quality construction of their houses.
- Those house which was constructed after the earthquake without following government compliance causes disturbance to the POs in relation to reconstruction of new HHs.

- It is very difficult to suggest those HHs which are under construction and also to convince those who have not followed appropriate building code.

Way Forward

- Design and drawing of buildings
- Day to day supervision of reconstruction.
- Technical orientation to beneficiaries on build back safer (BBS)
- Bridging the technical team with community.
- Delivery of government guideline to community level.

1.7.4 Build Change -Technical support -Mobina Ghimire

Build Change presented their experience on orientation (community / door to door) BBS / BBB strategy through presentation. Technical assistance by providing design and drawings to HHs, also shared their monitoring and supervision strategy of the building.

Challenges:

- Owner Driven Project-HHs decides.
- Each HH have different needs depending upon different circumstances.
- Released first tranche during Dashain festival.
- Due to financial limitations and lack of structural elements needed for earthquake resistant houses supported and focused more on technical part to build back better.
- Material Scarcity and transportation limitations.
- Lack of skilled and semi-skilled manpower.
- Lack of communication between PO's and Government Body.

1.7.5 Samaritan's purse - Abu raj Thapa

Housing Reconstruction (6 model houses), BBB/Mason trainings, Technical Assistance of all wards of Langtang, Sawmill Operation for cutting of dead trees into beams and planks for housing reconstruction .

Challenges:

- Lack of skill manpower.
- Due to poor trail condition and lack of means of transport in langtang , it is difficult to transport foodstuffs and construction materials.
- It is really hard to give technical advice during construction and convince them. It was also difficult to participate local people during trainings time.
- Due to cold weather and difficult site condition, mainly on upper part of the VDC.

1.6.6 Nset (BailoGhar) : Ayush Baskota

Support to the GON's in relation to owner driven model of housing reconstruction by promoting disaster resilient construction standards and building back safer in earthquake affected districts

Challenges:

- Replication and dissimilarity of similar program activities at VDC by partner organizations.
- Coordination with government organizations, political members in initial phase.
- How NGOs and INGOs are looked upon.
- Remoteness of the VDCs.
- Cognitive Biasness among local leaders in VDC.
- Houses constructed but do not meet government compliances.

Major Learning:

- Including government bodies, leaders and community stakeholders is the best way to conduct program to achieve the expected objectives.
- Need base assessment of VDC
- Full package technical assistance is must for safe reconstruction
- Continuous support and guidance is required to make communities understand the necessity of BBS.

1.6.7 DUDBC/DLPIU :

DLPIU deputy chief Mr.Dhira Phadera brief about progress report and also expressed joint strategy for technical assistance along with challenges and way forward.

Challenges

- Lack of physical resources
- Delay in housing reconstruction in upper part of district .
- Absence of social mobilizes

Way Forward

- Integrated Data management regarding housing reconstruction
- Encourage people to initiate construction of houses and sensitize to follow ERB construction practices
- Research on Earthquake resistant reconstruction designs for upper part .
- communities without dissimilarity

1.8 Workshop Output

1.8.1 Community/HHs orientation

Challenges:

- Minimum participants form local community.

- Busy in their own constructions
- High expectation of the community.
- Language Barrier
- Community seeks incentives during the participation.
- People are not interested in lecture methods of message delivery.
- Engaged in cultural and traditional functions and does not show much interest in favor of reconstruction.
- Difficult geographical topography.
- Absence of government representative during the sessions.
- Time management (especially for women's)

Way Forward:

- Coordinate with Local stakeholders.
- Mobilization of local social mobilize (SM) in respective VDCs.
- Timing should be arranged as per community people as the women's are busy more over with their household activities.
- Visual and audio should be used to attract community people's interest during the sessions.

1.8.2 Door to door technical assistance

Challenges:

- Follows traditional methods of construction.
- Insufficient budget for the reconstruction.
- Lack of technical knowledge and difficult for the beneficiaries to understand technical terminologies.
- Lack of skill manpower
- Unavailability of house owner during technical inspection.

Way forward

- Regular follow up by POs, DLPIU and VDC authorities.
- Proper orientation to the community and use local and traditional technical languages which can be easily understandable to the local people.
- Organize technical trainings and workshops at grass root level.
- Appropriate measures in relation to information and communication to the community.

1.8.3 Short training for mason

Challenges:

- Lack of practical knowledge
- Difficult to trace all those short term training participants because of inappropriate data management by the POs.
- Insufficient technical knowledge for skill man power.
- Participants were not regular during the training.
- Lack of young people during the training.
- Geographical topography cause difficult for people to attain trainings.

Way forward:

- Focus on practice knowledge rather than theory.
- Providing logistic support and allowance to the local people.

1.8.4 Vocational / on the Job training for mason**Challenges:**

- Insufficient land for construction.
- High expectation of labours.
- Political interference regarding selecting masons.
- Follow up mechanism.

Way Forward:

- Alternative participants should be recommended and finalize for the training.
- Appropriate orientation from POs and government in relation to labour law and their payments scale.
- Proper information should be delivered to the community and the selection of the mason should be done on the basis of community choice.
- Coordination bodies such as HRRP need to take lead.

1.8.5 Help desk / Technical support center**Challenges:**

- Lack of technical coverage and awareness.
- Lack of understanding regarding help desk
- Design not complied between government and partners.
- Hard to convince earthquake resilient technology.
- Landslide prone zone area.

Way Forward:

- Survey and needs of people.
- Awareness to the community regarding help desk through media.
- Provision of help desk in ward level.
- Mobilization of media
- Using Videography as a pull factor because most of the community had forgotten earthquake 2015.
- Approval and inspection of drawing of HHs.

1.8.6 Demonstration construction**Challenges:**

- Site selection.
- Government land
- Land registration
- Skill mason.
- Quality of locally available materials.

Way forward:

- Public place
- Appropriate land where community people can view easily.
- Train local mason for the constructions.
- Orientation and delivery of policies through media to reach maximum people in short period of time.

Annexes**Annex 1 :Registration of Participants**

SN	Name	Organization	Designation
1	Rojita Sharma	Build Change	Architect
2	Mobina Ghimire	Build Change	Deputyproject manager
3	Babu Ram Fyuba	DFID	DLMO
4	Sanjib Kumar Rai	Helvetas	Cluster coordinator

5	Mahesh Bhatt	ManekorSociety Nepal	DistrictprogramOfficer
6	Lal bahedur chmera	ManekorSociety Nepal	Sub engineer
7	Santosh Adhikari	Helvetas	Sub engineer
8	Jeevan Thapa	Lumanti	Civil engineer
9	Pawan Bhatt	NRCS	Shelter officer
10	Mocha nath Dhakal	DEPROSC - Nepal	Sub engineer
11	IBU Raj Thapa	SP	Engineer
12	Biren Lama	SP	Sub engineer
13	Chhatra bahadur Shah	DLPIU Rasuwa	Asst. sub engineer
14	Rajeev Gyawali	DLPIU Rasuwa	Engineer
15	Jagat raj Dangi	DLPIU Rasuwa	Sub engineer
16	Laxmi p. Bhatta	HRRP	National Technical officer
17	Ayush Baskota	Nset/ baliyo Ghar	District Coordinat
18	Ramesh Acharya	Cordaid	Field Coordinator
19	Keshav Gajurel	NRA Rasuwa	Field officer
20	Krishna kant upadhayey	NRA Rasuwa	Chief
21	Dhira Phadera	DLPIU Rasuwa	For project Chief
22	Ishower Kumar lama	LACCoS	Member
23	Sunil Ghale	LACCoS	Treasure
24	Rabi Sha	LACCoS	Engineer
25	Rijan Gajurel	HRRP	IM

Annex 2: Participants Attendance

One Day Technical Workshop on
 "Current Status of Technical Assistance in Reconstruction and it's Challenges"
 Attendance Sheet (HRRP Rasuwa)

Date : 14-Feb,2017

Location : LACCoS Hall , Dhunche Rasuwa

S. No.	Full Name	Agency	Designation	Phone No.	Email Address	Signature
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6.	Rojita Sharma	Build Change	Architect	9841917246	rojita@buildchange.org	[Signature]
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Thank You

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 Attendance Sheet (HRRP Rasuwa)

9.	Soumitra Bhattarai	NRA DCC	Under Secretary	9843588686	KKURU@Gmail	[Signature]
10.	Ramesh Acharya	Cordaid	Field Coordinator	984184296	Rameshacharya@gmail.com	[Signature]
11.	Bikesh Lama	Samaitan's Peace International Relief	Project Sub-Engineer	9844234580	lamabikesh@gmail.com	[Signature]
12.	Ibu Raj Thapa	Samaitan's Peace International Relief	Project Engineer	9843023966	ithapa@samaitan.org	[Signature]
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14.	Ryan Gajurel	HRRP	IM	9851114937	im.rasuwa@hrrpnepal.org	[Signature]
15.	Laxmi P. Bhattarai	HRRP	NTCO	9643112569	senofficer@nationalhrrpnepal.org	[Signature]
16.	Rajeev Gyawali	DLPIU Rasuwa	Engg.	9841169283	gyawali.rajeev@gmail.com	[Signature]
17.	Chhatra Bdr Shahi	DLPIU Rasuwa	ASIST Engineer	9848215638	ChhatraShahi394@gmail.com	[Signature]
18.	Jagat Raj Dangol	DLPIU Rasuwa	Sub-Engineer	9849632606	Jagat-Raj-Dangol@yahoo.com	[Signature]
19.	Ilhira Phadera	DLPIU Rasuwa	For Project Chief	9851061818	phaderadhira@gmail.com	[Signature]
20.	Ishwar Kumar Lama	LACCoS	Member		Hitungishwar@gmail.com	[Signature]

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Thank You

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Attendance Sheet (HRRP Rasuwa)

21.	Sunil Ghale	LACCOS	Tresure	9851058136		
22.	Rabi sha	LACCOS	incharge.			
23.	Mahesh Bhatt	Manekor	Society Nepal	District program officer		
24.	lal Badhur chumera	Manekor	Sub-engineer			
25.	Rijan Gajurel	HRRP-GoAL	IM	9851114931	im.rasuwa@hrrpnepal.org	
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Thank You

Annex 3: Photographs





One day Technical workshop on
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Update form DLPIU for project chief Mr.Dhira Phadera



Update form NRA district head, Mr . Krishna kanta upadhayey



Thank You